

UNDERGROUND AND OVERGROUND



As a city grows busier, the traffic on the roads becomes heavier and slower. This problem often can be solved by building a railway across the city, either over it, on tracks raised above the roads, or under it! There are underground trains all over the world, from London, where the world's first underground railway was built, to Moscow, where stations are like palaces. But they all do the same job—keep people moving.

No smoking

The first underground railroad opened in London in 1863. It used steam trains, but the smoke often made it impossible to see in the tunnels. The answer was electric trains, which were introduced in 1890.



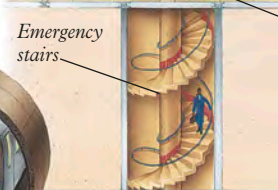
A tight squeeze

So many people travel on the underground trains in Tokyo, Japan, during the rush hour, that special “pushers” are employed to squeeze passengers into the cars.

The London Underground is also called the “tube” because the deep tunnels are built using steel tubing. Tunnels near the surface are dug like ditches and then covered over.



Underground trains are powered by electricity picked up from extra rails.



Emergency stairs